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The Customer Health Compass

Customer health as five dimensions, not one number

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The Customer Health Compass

Product Adoption

Have they adopted the product fully into their operations, or is usage still shallow and occasional? This dimension asks whether the product has actually become part of how the customer works day to day -- not whether they logged in this week, but whether the team would genuinely notice if it disappeared tomorrow. Low adoption is often the earliest visible signal of risk, because everything else on this compass tends to follow from it.

Business Outcomes

Are they achieving the results they originally intended to use the product to achieve? This is the dimension that matters most to whoever signs the renewal, and it's the one most easily missed by a CSM who's close to the day-to-day relationship but hasn't recently checked back against the original goal. A customer can score well here even with modest usage, if that usage is precisely targeted at the outcome that matters.

Relationship Strength

Do the right people -- not just a single friendly contact -- know, trust, and engage with the account team? A relationship that depends on one champion is fragile by definition, however warm it feels. This dimension asks about coverage and depth across the stakeholder map, not just the quality of the best relationship in the account.

Customer Sentiment

What does the customer actually say, unprompted, about the experience -- not what a survey score implies, but what comes up in real conversations, support tickets, and QBRs? Sentiment can diverge sharply from usage data: an account can be heavily used and quietly resentful, which is one of the most dangerous combinations on this compass because it rarely shows up in a dashboard until it's already a churn risk.

Growth Potential

Is there a natural next problem this account is positioned for the vendor to help solve? This dimension isn't about whether the vendor needs the revenue -- it's about whether the account's own trajectory is creating a genuine opportunity. A healthy score here is a signal to watch for the right moment, not a reason to start a pitch early.

Using the Compass, Not Just a Score

The value of scoring five dimensions separately, rather than blending them into one number, is that it tells a CSM exactly where to focus. An account with strong Adoption and Outcomes but weak Relationship Strength needs a very different intervention than one with the opposite pattern -- and a

single blended health score would show both accounts as roughly the same shade of amber, hiding the very different actions each one actually needs.

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About the Author

David Maika is a Customer Success professional with experience spanning customer operations, process improvement, CRM implementation, project management, and business strategy. His work focuses on helping organizations improve customer outcomes, strengthen operational efficiency, and build scalable systems that support long-term growth.

Through practical frameworks, real-world case studies, and modern AI-assisted workflows, he aims to make Customer Success knowledge accessible, actionable, and valuable for professionals at every stage of their careers.

To learn more, access additional resources, or connect professionally, visit davidmaika.com or linkedin.com/in/davidmaika.

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